ECC REDMOND | MARCH 8, 2026

The Power to Reconcile

Sunday School — Middle Schoolers (Grades 6–8)

Romans 5:1-11

🎮

Would You Do It?

I'll read a scenario. Move to the LEFT side for YES,
RIGHT side for NO WAY.

← YES, I'd do it

NO WAY →

SCENARIO 1

Would you give up your phone for an entire month to help a friend pass a class?

SCENARIO 2

Would you eat lunch alone every day for a week so a new kid wouldn't have to?

SCENARIO 3

Would you give away your entire savings to pay for someone else's medical bill?

SCENARIO 4

Would you take the blame for something you didn't do to protect your best friend?

SCENARIO 5

Would you risk your life to save a stranger?

SCENARIO 6 — THE HARD ONE

Would you risk your life to save someone who hates you and has been mean to you?

That last one is hard, right?

Who would actually do that?

That's exactly what Jesus did for us.

"In Sunday's sermon, we heard about how God reconciled us to Himself — not when we were good, but when we were still His enemies."

Key Verse

> *"But God demonstrates his own love toward us in that while we were still sinners, Christ died for us."*
>
> — Romans 5:8

Key Idea 1

Reconciliation Is One-Sided

- When friends fight, **both** usually have to apologize
- With God, the broken relationship was **entirely our fault**
- God didn't wait for us to fix ourselves — He made the **first and only move** by sending Jesus
- Reconciliation = the relationship is **fully repaired**, not because we earned it

Think About It

In the Old Testament...

- Moses had to be **shielded** from God's full glory
- Only the high priest could enter the Most Holy Place — **once a year**
- They tied a **rope around him** in case he didn't survive

Now, because of Jesus, we can approach God freely.

Key Idea 2

The Depth of God's Love

- **Romans 5:7** — Maybe someone would die for a really good person
- **Romans 5:8** — Jesus died for us when we were **not good at all**
- Knowing we would **continue to sin**, Christ still died for us

The Hero's Sacrifice in Movies

- Avengers: Endgame
- The Lion King
- Big Hero 6
- Saving Private Ryan

In every story, the survivors **change their lives** because of the sacrifice.

Are we living differently because of what Jesus did?

Key Idea 3

Suffering Builds Hope

Suffering → Perseverance → Character → Hope

- Muscles get stronger only when they're **pushed past comfort**
- God uses hard things to **stretch our faith** and grow us
- This doesn't mean God wants us to be miserable — He's **building something in us**

A Change of Perspective

Microscope

Makes **small problems** look huge

→

Telescope

Shows how **massive God's love** really is

Stop magnifying your problems. Start seeing God's love at full size.

Recommended Video (8 min)

BibleProject: Romans 5-16 Overview

Click to open in YouTube — covers Romans 5-16 themes including reconciliation, suffering, and hope

KEY TAKEAWAY

> *"When we can witness the depth of God's love, we can handle true suffering in life — because we are reconciled to God for all time."*

Small Group Time

Split into groups of 4-5 with a leader

Share honestly. Ask questions. Listen to each other.